



THE ICONOCLAST

Vol 2, Issue 1

1/30/97

Intellectual Barbarism by andrea chrisman

War. Let's make bigger and better bombs. I think of Hiroshima. I think of the thousand nuclear warheads, and how we ever got to this point with our bigger and better brains. Do we cherish life so much? Not just our own, but all life as we know it? Nuclear Winter is really frightening, as is the thought of Saddam Hussein having the potential power to blow us to smithereens. We've used our heightened intellect and reason to find more painful ways of annihilating each other. And another president candidate declares war to win the election.

What we should do is put our brains to better use, like for instance, finding an alternative to nuclear annihilation. Instead of army grunts, why not recruit computer geeks into the military? Microsoft could merge with all the computer greats of the NATO countries. From there, they can develop the ultimate "WARGAMES." Instead of killing people, video games would decide colonization. If Kuwait wins against Iraq, Kuwait gets Iraq. Iraq surrenders its government, and until challenged successfully, Kuwait maintains rule. Should Saddam Hussein ever wish to declare war on the United States, his computer geek militia would have to be formidable competition for Bill Gates. It could be like RISK on computer. There should, of course, be a disadvantage to countries with lesser armies, and governments should still have to pay big bucks for weapons. Nuclear Bombs cost 10 million dollars. Make the check payable to Microsoft, Inc. and get it on 4 floppy disks. Machine guns, planes, stealth bombers, military fortresses all have to be accumulated on disk using the tax money of the poor (that should make republicans happy). Credit will be given to each country's government for all the military assets they currently possess irl (in real life for the computer illiterate). No more real life guns and ammo will be made anywhere. They will become obsolete. Of course local law enforcement will begin collecting all the household arms and fire power leaving only antiques

not suitable for firing. Global security teams will begin covert operations to ensure no little countries are perfecting any other form of armament. And naturally, there will be pirating of software, but as this qualifies as covert operations and has been an acceptable means of obtaining government secrets for many centuries, this will be acceptable. Besides, since Microsoft clearly controls 50% of everything (Disney owning the other 50%), I doubt that rebel manufacturers will find it more profitable to work as spies. Most of these people will find the benefits package at Microsoft quite appealing once Microsoft begins manufacturing the software for its WARGAMES.

The war zone will be on an island in the middle of the Atlantic ocean, and UNIX systems will be set up to a network system linked, making paired systems of 1 per country linked to each other country. There will be a highly effective security system changed on a weekly basis controlled by a neutral country of Europe, say Switzerland, and this will ensure that no tampering takes place with the system.

Should the business chose a side, they will immediately be eliminated from the process, and be allowed no further --official-- profit. Should the country in which these major corporations operate ever be taken over by a country that is not democratic, they will be given free asylum to move to any country of their choice. The makers of the games, the security systems and the software will of course be allowed no governmental ties. Their role is simply profit. And since big business controls most of our country's activities as it is, this will come as no surprise to the Americans that big business will command all the major operations of the WARGAMES.

Let governments fight their wars on the Information highway, and not on our doorsteps. This will insure that not another innocent life is lost to war (except perhaps those few casualties of pirating operations that go awry).

POESIE:

Whirlwind by amie popp

Spirals of doubt
in my mind
like twisters
heading towards
the playground
infuriating seesaw slides swings merry go round
encircled by the dust
I stay away from the motion.

A certain whirlwind
to the rides
losing grip
falling
into the arms of motion.

A fall always accompanies
whirlwinds
dusty bruise
I am content
sitting on the bench.

"My Father" by Matthew W. Weatherbee

i stand defenseless to his yells,
like an embittered victim he screams;
at me?—
at me as though i was the object of his torment,
my torment his.
fear leaches from me to feed the power leech that stands
before me,
i stand wavering like a flag raised high in the wind;
at attention he holds me
lectures me
dilutes me
degraded.
i am standing in wait
for the freedom only he can grant me.
I love him for that.
Shit fuckin' scumbag

And now for the conclusion of

PLAYTIME: Part II-an Evolutionary Change. by Nicole Nader

You better watch out, you better not cry, you
better not pout, I'm telling you why....PC Barbie has
come to town!

Smaller, shorter and slightly chunkier than the
average doll, Politically Correct Barbie resembled an
unhappy toy sprung from the land of misfits; rather than

I just wanted to say... by amie popp

I am here today
to talk about you and me.
I just wanted to say...

I have been feeling dismay
about how we disagree.
I am here today.

Do you want me to stay?
Do you want to be free?
I just wanted to say...

What happened on Friday?
Since, I've been in agony.
I am here today.

Please talk...and convey
your feelings to me.
I just wanted to say...

Am I wrong to feel gray
about our lost harmony?
I am here today.
I just wanted to say.

"Filthy Pig" by Matthew W. Weatherbee

I save pennies not just to be thrifty
I save them; in a little piggy

in a pig left untouched
an unholy pig, a pig that sows
I sow too, but not with my nose
sowing a fortune
for a future
one penny at a time

I touch not the pig
hoping to be filthy

rich with pennies
and rich with granduer

I hope to be as rich as a pig

from the pages of "Seventeen" or "Sassy." From day to
day I scribbled over her pale rubber frame with washable
crayola markers (all in Earth tones) to give her that
versatile "ethnic look." PC Barbie came to the
wonderland with a very definable goal in mind; she
wasted no time and went straight to her work.

PLAYTIME: Part II-an Evolutionary Change Continued—

The local eateries and shops weren't functioning productively because of a total lack of employment. PC Barbie changed all this by encouraging the Barbies and Kens of the playroom to spend those long, boring lethargic hours (while I was at school) working at the local tissue box or possibly flipping burgers at the Barbie McDonald's Restaurant. The dolls agreed in hopes that they might enhance their physique this way.

Barbie #1, the head of the menagerie, decided to plunge into the job market first. After searching for several stressful days, she managed to find a lucrative position as an official ice cream scooping technician at the local Ice Cream Soda Shoppe. While I suspected she would have rather had a managerial position at the local xerox box stacked mini-mall, not a glimmer of disappointment showed in her painted smile.

Barbie #1 took this career change rather seriously. She retired her pink heels to the back of the

closet and acquired a more subdued wardrobe consisting of flats and three quarter length suits.

Barbie #1 held her own in this fast paced new, cut-throat world. She soon began to breed industrious and innovative thoughts into her head, and thus, she kept her eye on the very prestigious position of head cashier. Just think of all the doors it opened!

PC Barbie, the pacifist, stood back and looked onto her creation. This brought a whole new movement among the Mattel community enabling them to succeed, build character, and learn the value of the treasured Monopoly money. Even preteen Barbie wanna-bes like skipper and Kristie, who had flat feet held after school jobs. And so, all began to prosper...PC Barbie didn't go away, she slowly assimilated herself into society. I even hear she dyed her hair blonde for a change of pace. Who knew? Yup, all's well that ends well in this valley of the dolls. Possibly most important of all, Ken discovered he possessed talent that far surpasses the out-of-leg bending.

From the Pens of Bitch & Moan: An Ode In Prose To The Serendipitous Pseudonym

by Sir Wellington Bitch III

Greetings and salutations! Sir Wellington Bitch III here! I come to guide you all, the honored unwashed, to a plane of mental nirvana. I will accomplish this with the considerable scope of my enlightened mind and humble manner of presentation. This I do out of love for the finer things in life, lest they be soiled by the minute and unmastered mentality of a certain upstart hick! And since discretion is a virtue, I shall refrain from mentioning the name of said blathering bumpkin. I would not profane my discourse by giving my hemorrhoid of a literary rival a name...aaaa.....aaaaaa.....AAACHOOORUTHERFORDB MOAN!!! Ahem! Pardon me! But I digress! Let us proceed to the subject of this week's (as the oh so cultured French might say) Ode Le Bitch...THE PSEUDONYM!

OOOOOOOO PSEUDONYM! Thou noble pseudonym! Let me delve into thy etymological richness! Pseudo, from the Greek, meaning "like", only to be followed by more Greek, nym, which means "name"! Oh, clever ones, those ancient Greeks! They made more than gyros and wooden horses! Without your blessed existence, dear pseudonym, there would be no Mr. T, no Bozo the Clown, no Pee-Wee Herman! And what would the world do without the ever so handsome and melodic Englebert Humperdink?! (I hope I spelled your beautiful pseudonym correctly Mr. Dink! May I call you Hump? Humpy?!) And who could forget the one and only Slappy Stink Monkey, mascot of the

Iconoclast, last bastion of free speech in the civilized college world?! Why, pseudonym, without you, we would not be graced by your only begotten child, the euphemism! The world would simply not function without that polite and all-pleasing offspring! Think of it, oh course and common reader, how dreary and mean this world would be if they took away little baby euphemism! That child is the bearer of joy and political correctness, making us feel better as we are dubbed visually, vertically, and mentally challenged! Imagine the horror of instead being known as blind, short, and crazy again! Oh, I shudder at the very whim! After all, what would life be without a bit of challenge! HAHAAHAHAHAHAHAHAHAHAHAHAHAHAHAHAHAHA HA!

How very funny!

Well, There you have it! Allow yourself to bask for one more moment if the breathless ecstasy of the words that have just caressed your eyes! And beware of jealous, banjo-slapping men from the Moan clan! Gossip has it that one of them has actually stopped pleasuring himself long enough to desecrate paper and pen. If you come across a copy of his crayon scrawlings, replete with backwards letters and sentences that end with the word "is", be sure to use it for the purpose it is best suited...wipe yourself after visiting the bathroom. I must away! Until my next poetic interlude, ta ta! And as RuPaul says, "Keep a tight buttocks!"

The Unnecessary Necessity of Pseudonyms (a cuffing about the head with the stick of reason). by Rutherford B. Moan

You can call me Rutherford B. Moan. No doubt you have read the commentary by my esteemed colleague Sir Wellington Bitch the III and are no doubt wondering "Where is the side of reasoning and practicality here?" "Who will stop this rambling rhetoric on the necessity of false names?" You have heard his opinion, but now allow me to come down off the mountain and smite you with the CORRECT opinion. Hark, do I hear a drum role making my entrance? Indeed I do....

Pseudonyms. Nom de Plumes. Pen names. Bullshit Made-Up Writer's Names. Designs of a writer who cannot take responsibility for what they have to say. I understand that some writers, like Sir Stinky Pants over there, cannot have his delicate ego bruised when people say his point is wrong. However, mark the day when the people rave about his work for he shall come running through the streets saying "Hey! That Sir Beef Wellington guy is me! 'Tis I, the greatest writer in all the land!" If people want to complain about my work, they need only mosey to the iconoclast office and ask for Mr. Moan (I have regular office hours Monday through Friday).

Do you who use pseudonyms think that the masses of the world care who you really are? When the world found out the Richard Bachman, the Wizard of Oz and Mark Twain really are Samuel Clemmons, Stephen

King and that balding man (not necessarily in that order) the world stopped for a second, everyone said "oh that's nice," and went about their business. My colleague here is the chap who gets his paper read out loud in class, anonymously I might add because God forbid his precious delicate flowery little ego takes some face to face criticism, and babbles on about how great it is. Is Halloween your favorite holiday there, Mr. Sir Duke of Bitch Slap or whatever your name might be this week? Ha! Hide behind your falsehoods. If it's your fancy to prance around like a damned fool doing the Frisky Dance and proclaiming yourself Sir Slappy Stink Monkey, go ahead. I throw down my literary gauntlet in challenge for you to be more concerned about what you write instead of WHO you write as. If you, sir, wish to preach your bogus ideas from a bully pulpit masked by some witty nom de plume, do not do so near me.

And so concluded the voice of reason. I have spoken. Off I shall trot into the horizon with my esteemed partner (my esteemed partner whom I know the true identity of but shall not disclose out of some sort of respect for him I suppose. It's not like his profound writing would bring the commoners en masse to his doorstep with torches if they knew who he really was) to further inform you on the troubles of society another time. Thank you and goodnight.



Portrait of a Murderer by Andy Roberts

In his mind he had killed her many times. Each death was as brutal as the previous death; and the act never seemed to end the pain caused by her. He had killed in the war. But the killings were a necessity...to preserve his own life.



Killing her was different. The act would be premeditated, barbarous, inhuman, unforgivable. How could he end the life of someone he loved more than himself? Was she awful enough to kill?

As he wrestled with the questions, he opened the black, hard-plastic case. It was lined with gray foam meant to protect the valuable contents. He removed the shiny, black pistol and felt the weight pulling his hand down. It seemed heavier now than ever before. He checked the chamber to make sure it was unloaded. With a full magazine of bullets, he loaded the pistol and checked the safety lever to make sure it was in the "off" position. The pistol was ready and its weight increased.

He slid the top of the pistol back and caused a bullet to enter the chamber. "Killing's easy", he remembered from the war. With the muzzle aimed at its target, he pulled the trigger. The pain was gone.